A very cool grant title, 123456789

Data Management Plan

Principal investigator: A. B. Palaeontologist

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Institution: The Best University

Funder: European Research Council

Project start date: 01.09.2026
Project end date: 31.08.2031
An update date would be nice

No project summary

1 Data collection

1.1 What data will be collected or reused?

1.1.1 Occurrence and morphological data of arthropods

- Description: data entries of Palaeozoic arthropods, collated in spreadsheets with relevant contextual data and metadata.
- Volume: <2 GB

1.1.2 Photographs of arthropod fossils

- Description: photographs taken of museum and field arthropod fossils.
- Volume: up to ~10,000 photographs, so 10 GB

All data created will be preserved, and any relating to published output will be shared in online repositories.

No data on file formats; no idea if all new or some reuse; unrealistic volume

1.2 How data will be generated

- 1.1.1 will be generated through:
    - Reuse from online repositories of fossil specimen occurrences
      No detail on which repositories reuse data are from; no notes on citing or sharing permissions
    - Collation of data in the published literature
    - Recording of data entries for fossil specimens present in museum collections or found through field work during the project
- 1.1.2 will be generated through:
    - 2D photography

    - Reuse of CC-licensed photographs
      Where from? Publications, iDigBio?

2 Data documentation

2.1 Data documentation and structure

- Each folder will contain a README metadata file
  More detail on what is in the README: .txt, explains contents and file names, signposts any software needed
- Raw versions of all data files for 1.1.1 will be kept that are date-stamped and unedited to support transparency and reproducibility
- Photographs (1.1.2) will have unique identifiers (e.g., museum accession numbers) included in their filenames
- All data files will be shared within open formats as far as possible

Add details on folder structure
How will data be managed while the project is ongoing?

2.2 Software and code

- All code will be shared open access
  More detail would be helpful: any data with proprietary file formats that require conversion? Where to share code? Any software?

2.3 Standards

- 1.1.1:
    - All specimen occurrence data entries will have a unique identifier, usually their museum accession number.
    - Data structure will follow the Darwin Core taxonomy as far as possible (https://dwc.tdwg.org).
    - Data will be cleaned in accordance with the guidance published in Jones et al. (2025).
- 1.1.2: a scale bar will be included in at least one image of each photographed specimen.
- All data and their repositories will confirm to FAIR standards.

A good section

3 Data storage

3.1 Repositories

- Data will be archived on Zenodo. A Community will be created for the project that contains all data uploads.
- Code will be archived on GitHub.
- All repositories and the data stored within will confirm to FAIR standards, and data repositories used will always be non-profit organisations.

More detail on why these repository choices, backup plans if files are too large, local storage plans, when in the research process data will be stored in repositories…

3.2 Data format, indexing, versioning

- Open archival formats will be used for all data outputs where possible.
- All generated datasets (and software outputs) will be DOI-linked.
  Could detail that GitHub code will be released on Zenodo to give DOIs; why DOIs are important
- Versioning will be used for data files where needed – Zenodo allows for versioning and retains access to all versions.

3.3 Data preservation timeline

- At the least all data generated will be retained for 10 years after the project-end by storage in online repository and local HDD.
  Could locally stored data be backed up on an institutional server or similar?
  Always check repository retention time – Zenodo at least 20 years

3.4 Licensing and ownership

- Data will generally be licensed as CC-BY: allowing reuse, modification, distribution, etc., with attribution.

Who will the data ultimately be owned by? Check your institutional/funder policies
Include how you will handle potential embargo periods

4 Ethics, legal, and security issues

- No data will be generated that is confidential, personal or sensitive.
- The data generated pose a low security risk.

Need to add about museum specimens, as these are discussed in section 1: e.g., potential for sensitive metadata, discuss data sharing with curators in advance

5 Oversight of data management and sharing

The author will be responsible for implementing this DMP.

Add some info on who else has access to the data, or management rights (collaborators, students?)
Could add some references and/or links if helpful (to future you!)